MCP

Title:

Office Case

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(*Two upbeat office workers, Martin and Debby, sit at their cubicles. They work with energy, typing, clicking, coffee-sipping, and so on as they talk.)*

Martin: This has got to be the best batch of coffee Martha has ever made.
Debby: I know! In my three years at Moderninnovatech, this is by far the least chunky.
Martin: I've got such a caffeine-high, I could sell a million units at once.
Debby: I could rip a chair in half.
Martin: I could do basic math.
Debby: I could insert USB drives correctly on the first try.
Martin: Okay that's just ridiculous, Debby.
Debby: ...Martin?
Martin: I'm on the horn with a client, so. Go ahead. (to headset) No, not you, ya dumb-dumb. What's up, Debby?
Debby: Since this coffee means we could do anything… what do you actually want to do?
Martin: What do you mean?
Debby: Like. If you could choose to do anything in the world, what would it be?
Martin: Well, I'd love to sell you several units so I can make my daily quota and play paintball the rest of the afternoon.
Debby: I don't mean today, I mean--
Martin: (*to headset)* No, not you, I'm obviously talking to Debby. (*listens*) …"*Who's Debby"?!*
Debby: Martin, of course I'll buy several units to get you up to quota, but--
Martin: (*to headset*) You *don't know* who Debby is?! Well she's only my cubicle-mate, *annnd* Moderninnovatech's *third* most successful salesman. Out of salesmen whose names start with 'D' and 'E'.
Debby: Don't you ever think about what you want from life? Like. For the rest of it.
Martin: (*ponders a while*) No, I don't.
Debby: Neither did I. Until I drank this suddenly potable coffee.
Martin: (*holds up a finger*) Sorry Debbie, I was talking to this client. (to headset) Yeah you, ya big weirdo. (*to Debby*) Customers, am I right?
Debby: Usually my dreams take place in this office, because almost all of my life is spent here, but today… Thanks to this sweet cup of Martha's Joe, I can see my dream so, so clearly. I'm

gonna be an accountant! No, that's just 'cause I saw a calculator in the corner of my eye. I want to be a… window. No. A… tree, that's not it. A cubicle.
Martin: I'd love to be a tree that got made into a guitar.
Debby: Why don't you just be a guitar?
Martin: Why don't you just GET OFF MY BACK?! (*off Debby's shock*) Oh not you, Debby. This dumb client keeps asking to buy stuff.
Debby: Martin. Don't you see?!
Martin: Sixteen hours a day! ...Well, I do blink a lot, so maybe more like nine--
Debby: We've never thought about our dreams because we're always trapped here! Working our nine-to-nine jobs, just trying to make ends meet. It's like that song--"Despite my young age, I am still just a bat in a cave!"
Martin: Ooh, I love The Dashing Muchkins.
Debby: I just want-- (*turns*) Oh hey, Jeff and Janice.
Martin: Why the long faces?
(*We see Jeff and Janice's stoic faces barely poking over the cubicle wall*.)
Janice: Didn't you hear?
Jeff: Apparently not.
Debby: Hear what?
Martin: Did you guys finally lose a staring contest?
Janice: (*stares for a moment)* Moderninnovatech canceled vacation days.
Jeff: *Vacation* days.
Debby: Pfft, ha-ha. Good one. That's not possible.
Martin: I'm no lawyer but I watch TV sometimes and I'm pretty sure that's illegal.
Janice: Not in these corporate states of America.
Jeff: Read the memo if you don't believe.
Debby: Pfft, memos. Like a memo would say th-- (*reads a memo*) My god, they weren't kidding.
Martin: They canceled our vacation days?? Just like that?! Canceled! ...All of them??
Debby: Just like the vacations my parents promised when I was a kid. They're all canceled. I guess Moderninnovatech doesn't love us… maybe the company's getting divorced?
Jeff: I'm gonna go boil water to pretend I'm in Florida.
Janice: And I'll be sticking my head in the freezer to pretend I'm in Alaska.
Martin: After everything we've given this company. Multiple sales, thousands of dollars worth of coupon books…

Debby: I was in my mid-20's when I started here. I was GORGEOUS. Now I'm in my late-20's. And I am DISGUSTING. We'll never get that time back. Instead they just take more time away from us. Even this great coffee isn't worth that!
Martin: I was going to visit my dying father this year. Or go to Comic-Con. I can't believe they've done this. I was so excited to finally go to Comic-Con!
Debby: What even are we?
Martin: Humans?
Debby: If we just go along with this, keep pumping out record-low sales for this company while they take away our FREEDOMS, we may as well just be robots!
Martin: That would be pretty cool, actually. My knee does this weird clicky thing--
Debby: Martin. If we don't fight for our lives right now then we'll never be able to again!
Martin: Yeah! Can it wait 'til tomorrow? I'm pooped.
Debby: We may not be who we want to be. We may not *know* what we want to be. We may not have marketable skills or social acumen or basic hygiene. We may be broke, tired, and of sub-par intelligence. We may not floss every day--
Martin: Whoa, Debby. I've gotta stop this monologue of yours. I floss every day.
Debby: My point is… this is our opportunity.
Martin: For what?
Debby: Exactly!
Martin: ... I don't get it.
Debby: Let's find out! Don't you want to see what we're capable of?
Martin: Sure.
Debby: Don't you want to stick it to Moderninnovatech?!
Martin: I've stuck it to people for far less.
Debby: Then what are we gonna do?!
Martin: We're gonna rob this place blind!!!
Debby: Yeah!!! … Wait, did you just say 'rob this place blind'?
Martin: Uhm. Yeah?
Debby: Okay just making sure. That's what I was thinking, too!
Martin: All right!
Debby: Let's do it!

(*Later that night, Debby and Martin sneak throughout the office, searching every nook and cranny*.)

Debby: We've gotta find those keys if we want in the vault.

Martin: I can't believe Mr. Bossenheimer would hide keys to a room with millions of dollars of cash in it. Like, what if there's a money emergency??

Debby: Whoa, Martin! Here he comes!

Martin: Oh no. I'm out!

Debby: Martin?!

(*Martin ducks into a cupboard. Mr. Bossenheimer approaches Debby*.)

Debby: Hello, Mr. Bossenheimer!

Mr. Bossenheimer: Whoa, hey there Debby! Burning the midnight oil, eh?

Debby: No sir, I'm not a pyromaniac and my permanent record shows that I've never been convicted of arson, so don't even bother looking.

Mr. Bossenheimer: Ah. I just meant... you're working late. That's good to see! We need that kind of initiative around here.

Debby: Ah yes, working. That is what I am doing, Mr. Bossenheimer. Sticking around here. Totally what I'm doing, Bossenheimer--

Mr. Bossenheimer: Rob.

Debby: What?! Why would I rob--

Mr. Bossenheimer: Call me Rob.

Debby: Why would I do that? I've never thought of the word 'rob' before, and I never will again.

Mr. Bossenheimer: I just meant… Never mind. I'll let you get back to it.

(*He walks off. Debby opens a few cupboard doors. Finally opens Martin's and he pops out*.)

Martin: Phew, that was a close one.

Debby: Sorry I forgot which cabinet you put yourself in.

Martin: Happens with me and my children all the time. Did you happen to find the keys while I was in there?

Debby: No. I can't believe they aren't in the kitchen drawers. I know Mr. Bossenheimer has a set, but I also know that he probably wouldn't just hand them over for me to rob all of Moderninnovatech's cash. Except, maybe he would--we are on a first-name basis now.

Martin: What's his first name?

Debby: I can't remember.

Martin: Can you guess?

Debby: It starts with a letter. I know that.

Martin: Hm. I'm not sure that's enough. Maybe you should distract him and we'll steal them.
Debby: My teachers always did tell me I was great at distracting others…
Martin: See? Maybe this is what you were meant to be.
Debby: You mean… I've found… **my purpose?**
Martin: ...Well maybe, sure.
Debby: Let's do this. **Again.**
(*Mr. Bossenheimer is chilling in his office, bouncing and singing lightly along to a song. Debby sneaks in*.)
Debby: Hello again Mr. Bossenheimer.
Mr. Bossenheimer: Whoa, oh Debby you scared me. Why'd you sneak up on me like that?
Debby: Sneak, no. I'm not. I just. New shoes, you know. *Super quiet*. As I requested. Not. Um. You know what I was thinking? Is a funny word? 'Keys'. (laughs) I mean, who thought of that, right?
Mr. Bossenheimer: Huh. I guess I never thought about that. You're right, that is weird.
Debby: You have keys, right? I mean, we all have keys. Mine go to my car, my apartment... Maybe yours go to a house, a different car, and uh, I don't know. Maybe like a giant stockpile of cash?
Mr. Bossenheimer: (chuckles) Now I'm just thinking about how silly the word 'keys' is.
Debby: Right, like it makes me want to just take out all the keys I have and go… (takes out her keys, yells at them) 'Ahh you're such a silly word!' Right? Join me.
Mr. Bossenheimer: You want me to take out my keys and yell at them?
Debby: **Just do it, Bossenheimer!**
(*He shrugs, reaches in both of his pockets*.)
Mr. Bossenheimer: Okay then. (at his keys) You're so silly!
Debby: I like yelling at them for specifically what they are, like. Dumb car key! Dumb apartment key...
Mr. Bossenheimer: I don't know if I need to--
Debby: **You need to.**
Mr. Bossenheimer: Well. I guess I do have a pretty stupid house key. And car key. And vault key--
Debby: Right? So dumb. Like it makes me wanna just…
(*She grabs his keys, shaking them all*.)
Debby: Shake 'em up!!!
Mr. Bossenheimer: Whoa there, be careful.

Debby: Oh I will. Here you go, here are all of your keys. I'm sure you're not missing any. Don't even bother checking. Okay great talk Mr. Boss, see ya later!

Mr. Bossenheimer: Uh, okay--

(*Martin and Debby rush to the vault and pull out the keys*.)

Debby: All right, this is it. The key to our futures.

Martin: I thought it was the key to the vault.

Debby: Yes but inside the vault is our futures.

Martin: I thought there was money in there? Aw man, we did all this for 'futures'? What a bummer. I don't even know what those are.

Debby: No, it's… Okay I'll just open it.

(*She puts the key in, twists. The door opens and their jaws drop with amazement.*)

Debby: Wow...

Martin: It's so…

Debby: Empty.

Martin: Yeah. I guess there's nothing in our futures.

(*Jeff and Janice pop up from behind a table.)*

Janice: You're late.

Jeff: Very late.

Debby: Wh-- what? What. I don't. How are you two.

Martin: Why are you two…

Debby: What?

Martin: How.

Debby: Why?

Martin: Quoi?

Debby:Que?

Martin: Pasa?

Janice: We were late too.

Jeff: Too late.

Debby: You mean…

Martin: Someone else robbed this place blind?

Debby: Before we could?

Martin: Before you could?

Debby: Before you or we could?

Janice: Martha got here hours ago.

Jeff: Coffee-high.
Janice: She was here before them two.
Jeff: *Too*.
(*They turn to see two downtrodden co-workers waving.)*
Debby: Aw man. And here I thought we were special.
Martin: It just goes to show you. If you ever think you're special, don't.
Debby: But now what do we do with our lives? We can't work here anymore. I'm too lazy to return Bossenheimer's keys.
Martin: I was really looking forward to having freedom. Time to think about what I want to think about. Or just play some paintball.
Debby: Hey… why can't we be free? I mean, what's stopping us from walking out that door, casting aside all of our responsibilities, our shackles of modern living, and finding who we really are? Why can't we go explore who we want to be?
Martin: Money.
Debby: Oh. Yeah. I forgot about money…
(*The next day, they're back at their desks working away.*)
Martin: Moderninnovatech, how can I help you?
Debby: You can't.
Jeff: You guys too?
Debby: Don't remind us.
Martin: Yeah, especially when I'm on the phone. (*to headset*) No, you shut up too.
Janice: We've got a plan.
Jeff: Yeah.
Janice: A good plan.
Jeff: I think.
Debby: What is it? Stalk people over their cubicle walls?
Martin: Talk in weirdly sterile patterns? (*to headset*) No, I wasn't telling you to do that… Although you're pretty good at that.
Janice: Far better.
Jeff: We…
Janice: Are going…
Jeff: To rob…
Janice: Fort Knox...
Jeff: Blind.

(*Debby and Martin look to each other, interested*.)

Debby: Now that's a smart plan.

Martin: I'll finally be able to focus on my paintball career. (*to headset*) Please stop listening to my conversations, sir. Let's go get our futures!

Debby: Let's go!

Martin: Comic-Con, here I come!

Debby: Life-purpose, here I come!

Jeff: Florida. Here I come.

Janice: Alaska. Here I come.

Martin: Okay, no one really cares about your things…

Debby: Yeah.

Martin: Let's just stay excited for our things.

Debby: Yeah.

Martin and Debby: The futures!